

Motion Density Vocabulary

Shared terms for briefing, reviewing and pricing our motion graphics videos. v1 - Sept 2026

DENSITY - how much meaningful information and motion is packed into every second, without clutter. Measured with 6 sub-terms and rated D1 to D5.

1. The 6 density sub-terms

Sub-term	What it measures	Abwab v2
Beat rate	How often something new happens on screen	every 1.5-2s
Layer count	Animated layers on screen at the same moment	3-5
Data load	Real numbers / proof points per scene	2-4
Motion vocabulary	Number of distinct techniques (typewriter, cascade, pill wipe, smear, scan...)	~10
3D share	% of runtime that uses real 3D	~40%
Sound sync	% of beats that land with a sound hit	~80%

2. Density levels (the ladder)

Level	Beat rate	Layers	Data load	Techniques	3D share	Sound sync	Feels like
D1	4s+	1-2	1	3	0%	~30%	Kinetic text, simple slides
D2	~3s	2-3	1-2	5	0-10%	~50%	Clean explainer
D3	1.5-2s	3-5	2-4	~10	20-40%	~80%	Abwab v2 (our standard)
D4	1-1.5s	5-7	4-6	15+	40-60%	~90%	3D product mockups, faster cuts
D5	under 1s	7+	6+	20+	60%+	100%	Flagship: full 3D world, composed audio

3. Supporting terms

Beat	One new event: a number counting, a card landing, a word revealing.
Hero moment	A big "wow" shot (3D doors, logo landing). Aim for 3-5 per minute.
Brand fidelity	Only real client assets: logo, colours, numbers, UI. Nothing invented.
Locked camera	Camera never orbits or tilts. Only objects move. Push-ins allowed.
Frame-check	Stills of every beat reviewed before any full render.
Rung	One step on the quality ladder (one video = one rung).
Hold	A deliberate pause so the viewer can read. Density is not chaos.
Free audio	Only copyright-free, commercial-use music and SFX. Paid licence only if the client pays.

4. How to brief with it

- "Make this rung D4: beat rate 1-1.5s, 3D share 50%."
- "Data load is low in Act 2, add 2 real numbers per scene."
- "Add a hero moment at the logo reveal, keep the locked camera."
- "Sound sync is weak in the middle, every beat needs a hit."
- "Too dense here, add a hold after the headline."